

Long Thoughtful Blog

So, as you can tell by the pictures that we've been posting, me, my girlfriend and a few friends of ours have been practicing Acrobatic Partner Yoga. This is something that is very new to all of us and it has been quite an exciting journey. We sort of started playing with it about 6 months ago, but really got into it about two months ago, and I am totally hooked, however I have discovered something unexpected.

I have always been active and fit, I was a highschool athlete and then in collage I spent quite a bit of time in the weightroom. During my college years I was an amateur MMA Fighter (1 loss out of 6 fights) and basically worked out 7 days a week. After college I became pretty active in the earlier days of Parkour and pushed my body to do things I would have never thought possible. After that, I ended up becoming the manager of a cattle ranch and spent a couple years throwing hay bales, herding cattle by foot across hundreds of acres (until I learned how to ride a horse) and literally wrestling 200+ pound calves. During this whole time I was training explosive power, endurance, and balance, I reached new levels of strength each time I mastered something new.

However, now that I'm training in AcroYoga, things are quite a bit different. In each session, since I am not doing anything I perceive to be a strenuous activity (holding someone on my feet is nothing like halter breaking a 400lb calf, or fighting someone for 9 minutes), we tend to go for two or three hours in our sessions, it's fun, bonding, and rewarding. By the end, I don't feel tired, but my legs don't move quite as fast as they did when we started, I lose balance seemingly more often, and our tricks don't go quite as planned. So we stop and move on to the rest of our day happy and relaxed.

The next day is when it gets interesting and unexpected... Simply... I'm sore. Now, this would seem normal after a workout, however, it's a different kind of sore. In the weightroom after leg day, my quads, hams, and glutes hurt in a way that makes the toilet an instrument of fear. After chest day, my pec's, bi's, and tri's make holding a phone to my head torture. But after Acro, I absolutely can not pinpoint the muscles that hurt... at all. It's this weird overall feeling of soreness that's constant, yet not... In an area that I can't find, yet it's there. Unfortunately, this has been going for about two months now... I take my protein, glutamine, and MSM for recovery, but still, the soreness, the aching is there, and constant. The pain is always there... and I love it.

Ultimately I know, this soreness is making me stronger. It's making me better. When I thought I was at my peak level fitness, this is showing me that throughout my years and journey of physical improvement, there are things in my body that I now know have been very neglected. Through AcroYoga I am now taking care of those needs. As a base and a flyer in this neat activity I am growing, developing, and emerging into the next level of myself and my fitness. The old quote is that "pain just is weakness leaving the body", I really believe this constant soreness is truly that. The old me is slowly being replaced with the new me, and I am incredibly excited to see how I turn out :-)

Angry Letter:

So I don't typically give reviews or feedback to the stores that I visit, but on my visit to two of your locations I felt the need to let you know what was going on with your staff.

So, a little background about me, I first started shopping with Jos. A Bank in college when I lived in Northern Colorado. It was the only higher end mensware store and I was in school for business at the time so it was the most logical place for me to get some suits. After falling in love with the quality and service, I decided to invest quite a bit of my money at the time to build a wardrobe that I would be able to use for years to come, which I did, and it served me well. My wardrobe has landed me interviews that I wouldn't have otherwise gotten, and the jobs that followed. It has gotten me out of traffic tickets, into lunches with new clients and business contacts, and even the wonderful woman I live with now. I find that the clothes I wear are a very important part of my life.

So after moving back to Denver, I started a couple small business that moved me out to Castle Rock, and

have since gotten a place out in Perry Park. After moving the large amount of clothes in my closet for the 3rd time in just a couple years, I decided that I could do without quite a few of them, and update even more. So I spent a couple days going through everything I own most of which is Jos A Bank, and decided to bring back what didn't work for me.

The closest store to me now is in the Outlets at Castle Rock, and as I entered the store with my items I was greeted by the associate, I let him know that this looks like a lot, but it should work out for the store today. He said okay and got my information. We walked over to the front desk I set some things down and he informed me that he would not be able to do the return because he didn't have the sku's for the item. I asked him if he could look up my purchase history and just pull it from there, and he said since it was over a year old, and he didn't have the item in the store I would have to go to the store at the Park Meadows Mall and they would be able to assist me. I asked him if it would be possible to call them and get the information, and he stated he could but it would take a lot of time and they wouldn't want to do it because they work on commission and he wouldn't be paid for doing it. I was a little shocked at that answer but didn't argue, so I asked him one more time even though this is a Jos. A Bank store, and he has the same corporate system as the Park Meadows store, that Park Meadows would be able to do something Castle Rock can't. He said "Yes". So I thanked him and left, and he was polite enough to offer me a bag to help carry out my items.

So I made the 15 mile drive to the Park Meadows Mall walked in with my items and was excited to see that they were quite a larger store with many new Joseph items in stock, some nice updated ties, and quite a few things I was interested in. I decided that I would be spending some time there and getting some nice new items. As I approached the Manager I said basically the same thing, that I was looking to exchange quite a few items but it should work out for the store today. and he looked at them, scowled at me and said since he no longer carries these items in stock he could not do the return. I was very confused so I told him it was my understanding that the return policy stated I could return the items I purchased here at any time for any reason (as I was told many times when I made a purchase) he sharply stated "well I don't know where you heard that" and I was honestly taken aback. So I asked "well if that's not the return policy what is?" he told me that "I had up to one year from the time of purchase and could only return it if it was damaged or there was a manufacture defect" so I asked him if he could show me that in writing anywhere. then he stated "well it's my personal opinion that after years of having an item no one should return it" To which I replied, "I understand that, but what is your company's official policy and would you please show it to me." So he literally pushed the clothes away from him, gave me a terribly nasty look and stormed off into the back room for about 5 minutes. He came back visibly upset and stated, well I don't know where we keep it because I am new to this store, but I can do a refund for you and we will mail you a check. I stated "well I was hoping to do an exchange" ...but before I could finish he said "but it's going to take a lot of time and a lot of effort looking up the SKU's, and I'll give you the lowest possible price on each item." ...I was pretty shocked. But instead of arguing I said "that's fine" He said he would refund me \$39.95 back for each coat and \$19.95 back for each pant, and \$9.95 back for each shirt, then he had one of his associates show me around the store while he started. The gentleman who showed me around was very polite we talked for a few, I decided I needed a couple new white shirts, but I wouldn't be purchasing anything else that day. Which was unfortunate. About ten minutes later I tried to make small talk and asked if it was going alright to which he glared at me and said "it's a lot of work" and stormed off. so I looked around the store for a bit longer until he was ready to finish the transaction, I tried one more time to make small talk and tried to show him my Leather Jos. A. Bank wallet, which he glared at and said nothing. He said nothing much more than please sign these that the check would be mailed off in a week.

I went back to my car and noticed that he did not actually return the prices that we agreed on and did not give me the sale price on the shirts that I purchased, which at this point did not surprise me. At this point I had to be off to a meeting, and I figured I wouldn't get anywhere talking to him.

Unfortunately I don't think I will be shopping at the Castle Rock or the Park Meadows location anytime soon which is too bad because those are the two closest stores near me, but there is a Brooks Brothers at the outlets so I may try and see what values they have there.

David Bee Hero's Journey

For my entire adult life I was stuck in the same routine, work at a job for a couple of years, get mad at management, quit, and find a new one. I'd pick up a hobby on my days off, set it aside then start a new one. If I was lucky, I would even find someone who was wonderful to date, but I never ended up staying in the relationship for one reason or another.

Finally, I decided I was done with retail and could make it on my own, so joined the entrepreneurship world.

A couple of years passed so did various dbusiness ideas and product launches. One day it dawned on me that my cycle of self-sabotage hadn't changed. I was just doing things that "felt" more productive, with no lasting results. So, I decided to discover why...

After leaving my salaried job, I assumed things were difficult due to my ADHD. Learning new technology, networking, and sales systems, yes it was a lot, but that's not why I kept failing.

I met other entrepreneurs, did a few joint ventures, and plotted out different plans. I finally launched my first corporation and my first physical product. As things got real, my business partner ghosted me, but, that's not why I failed.

I started over, created a new plan, launched Colorado Mastermind, formed a new incredible strategic partnership, invested in a coach, and learned more in a few months than the previous 3 years of trial and error. However, another failure was just around the corner...

Even though I now had technical skills and business knowledge, there was still something holding me back. My peers were literally making 6 and 7 figures with the same skill set and resources I had, and the realization hit me like a cheap punch to the gut... I was still cursed with a cycle dragging me back down into mediocrity.

It took me an investment of about \$10,000 over the course of two years and at least a dozen failures to actually understand the mechanisms behind why I kept repeating the same habits in not just my business, but my financial, and intimate life as well. It wasn't what I expected, and the answer nearly broke me.

I'd finally found real help, I knew I needed to fix something wired in my brain that I couldn't see or understand. I was able to take advantage of a rare immersive psychological workshop. It was months of prep work full of scientific reading, and deeply introspective exercises, culminating in fully immersive days led by (in my opinion) the world's best interpersonal relationship coach and an incredible trauma-based psychologist. Here, I had an emotional breakthrough that rocked me to the very core of my existence. I cried for the first time in well over a decade, and trust me, it was an ugly cry. I was broken, I was exposed, my emotional fortress was cracked open and for

the first time in my life I remembered something that was long buried, and suddenly, I wasn't the same person anymore. I understood. My cycle of failure was a protective mechanism forced into me as a child, and it never left.

No learned technical skill or business coach could have fixed this. My mind had to be unlocked with science, and only then could I discover the root cause, allowing me to use new tools to repair the damage.

Years later, after witnessing so many people I care about with incredible knowledge, passion, and love they want to share, repeatedly struggle and give up, I knew I had to share what I learned.

Obviously, in this course, we aren't going as in-depth as my journey, but I've taken what I found to be the most important tools, the ones that gave me a full snapshot of self-understanding and condensed them into a 5-day workshop. Everything in this course is based on science and psychology.

In my opinion, this is deeper than any motivational strategy, more practical than any tech skill, faster at potentially restructuring your mind than affirmations, and likely more permanent than meditation. In five days, your outlook on the world could be altered forever.

The good news is that anyone who invests in these tools today will get all future updates at no additional cost!

Don't miss this opportunity, at the lowest price it'll ever be offered.